

Ryan Kovatch

Pentester & Web Security Specialist

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EXPERIENCE

UNIVERSITY OF OREGON

FOUNDING STUDENT SOC ANALYST | TEACHING SECURITY OPERATIONS CENTER

Jul 2025 – Jul 2026 | Eugene, OR

- Helped found an educational SOC for cybersecurity students to learn industry skills in: threat intel, vuln & attack surface management, incident response, etc.
- Researched and deployed open-source vulnerability management (OpenVAS) and threat intelligence (MISP) platforms.
- Built in-house OSINT investigation tooling for student use.
- Documented important technical processes and architectural information.
- Wrote policies and procedures for SOC operations and compliance to align with best industry practices.

LEARNING ASSISTANT | COMPUTER SCIENCE DEPARTMENT

Apr 2023 – Dec 2024 | Eugene, OR

- Worked with students each spring in an Honors College class on using AI for good.
- Taught Python fundamentals: data types, conditionals, loops, functions, etc.
- Walked students through implementing AI/ML algorithms: k-nearest neighbors, naive Bayes, random forests, neural networks, etc.
- Helped students apply AI to real-world issues like wildfires and public health threats.

QA TESTER | CENTER ON TEACHING AND LEARNING

Jun 2022 – Jan 2025 | Eugene, OR

- Maintained the website for the National Center on Improving Literacy.
- Ensured functionality and consistency of web content across platforms.
- Worked closely with the lead software developer to test new functionality.
- Gathered and formatted data for migration between server software versions.

GOOGLE | BUG BOUNTY HUNTER

Nov 2019 – Present | Remote

- Pentested Google infrastructure as part of the Vulnerability Rewards Program.
- Submitted 10+ critical security vulnerabilities worth over \$30,000 total.
- Received multiple research grants to conduct further testing.
- Disclosed vulnerabilities publicly and shared research on Medium.
- Currently ranked in the top 10% of bug reporters globally.

PROJECTS

REDNS | UOREGON CENTER FOR CYBER SECURITY AND PRIVACY & NETSEC LAB

Sep 2025 – Jun 2026

- Developed a novel encrypted DNS protocol using registration-based encryption.
- Analyzed existing DNS security protocols (DNSSEC, DoH/DoT, DNSCrypt) to identify obstacles in deployment and adoption.
- Conducted research on emerging cryptographic methods and privacy technologies to identify future security trends.
- Designed a drop-in proxy to exchange encrypted ReDNS traffic with legacy DNS nameservers.

SKILLS

LANGS/Frameworks

- Python ●●●●
- C/C++ ●●●○
- Swift ●●○○
- HTML + CSS ●●●○
- JavaScript ●●○○
- Protobuf + gRPC ●●●●
- Regex ●●●●

TOOLS/PLATFORMS

- Git ●●●●
- Metasploit ●●○○
- Wireshark ●●●○
- Burp Suite ●●●●
- SentinelOne XDR ●●●●
- MISP ●●●○
- Docker ●●●●

RESEARCH AREAS

- Web App Security
- API Security
- Protocol Design
- Reverse Engineering
- Pentesting

EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF OREGON

MS IN COMPUTER SCIENCE

Sep 2025 – Jun 2026 | Eugene, OR

GPA: 4.11 / 4.3

BS IN COMPUTER SCIENCE —

CLARK HONORS COLLEGE

Sep 2021 – Jun 2025 | Eugene, OR

GPA: 4.0 / 4.3 — Magna Cum Laude

PHI BETA KAPPA HONOR SOCIETY

MEMBER

AWARDS

- Oregon Cyber Challenge Cup Winner (2025)
- SentinelOne ThreatOps Challenge Winner (2025)
- Phillip Seeley Scholarship